HYBRID AG
PRECISION NUTRITION

REVIEW DRAFT



HORTICULTURE / POST-HARVEST

Cherry post-harvest checklist

Post-harvest nutrition should reflect what the season has shown you. Work through these points with your agronomist to decide what needs correcting, how a DSA can inform the prescription and when to check the response.

01 Use this season's results to set priorities

- ☐ Use pack-out, fruit size and firmness results to focus the review on blocks where the nutrition plan may need to change. Consider crop load and seasonal conditions before attributing a result to nutrition.
- ☐ Review the response to previous applications using test results and crop performance, allowing for other seasonal influences before deciding what to repeat or change.
- ☐ Separate confirmed Nutrient limitations from suspected water, root or soil constraints before committing to further applications.

02 Use DSA to inform the next application

- ☐ See page 3 for what DSA measures, how it compares with a standard leaf test and the extra visibility it can bring to your nutrition decisions.
- ☐ Plan a post-harvest DSA with your agronomist while suitable leaves remain active. Read the paired results alongside soil and plant tests, recent applications and the block's condition.
- ☐ Build a seasonal trend with repeat DSAs at relevant crop stages. Comparable results, matched to applications and crop performance, can help you refine the following season's plan.

03 Address priorities while leaves are active

- ☐ Prioritise Nutrient corrections with your agronomist, allowing for the harvest date, canopy condition and time available for a useful response.
- ☐ Where the canopy is declining early, investigate irrigation, root and soil limitations before assuming an additional Nutrient application will resolve it.
- ☐ Match the application method and timing to the identified requirement and tree condition, without encouraging unnecessary late vegetative growth.

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A plan for your block

04 Set the prescription and the review

- ☐ Develop a Hybrid-Ag prescription around the requirements supported by the results. Agree where differences between blocks justify a different blend, rate or timing.
- ☐ Agree what a follow-up DSA or other assessment would need to show before continuing, adjusting or stopping an application.
- ☐ Carry unresolved soil constraints into the coming season's soil plan, with a clear next step for investigation or testing.

> DSA compares Nutrient concentrations in sap from different leaf ages. It informs the nutrition discussion; it does not directly measure stored carbohydrates, whole-tree reserves or Nutrient delivery to the fruit.

Priority limitation / evidence

DSA finding that changes the recommendation

Water / root / soil constraints to resolve

Prescription / rate / timing to agree

Expected response / how to assess it

Follow-up result / decision to review

Work through the post-harvest priorities with Josh.

Bring the test results and season's records you already have. Josh Richardson can discuss the next testing and prescription decisions with you. You can also register interest in a post-harvest webinar; dates and presenters are to be confirmed.

Hybrid-Ag Cherry Nutrition Playbook, Post-Harvest sections; Andrew Smith, Cherry Post Harvest presentation (29 March 2026); Hybrid-Ag Testing Guide 2026. Draft wording requires technical review before external use.

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DSA and standard leaf testing

Differential Sap Analysis (also called a Differential Leaf Extract Test) compares Nutrients in fluid extracted separately from young and older leaves collected together from the same block.

What the paired results add

Separate young and older leaf results help your agronomist investigate Nutrient concerns, prioritise follow-up and assess whether a prescription or its timing needs changing. The results are read with soil, water, crop growth and recent applications.

Comparison	Standard leaf tissue test	DSA / paired-leaf sap analysis
Sample	The crop-specific leaf or plant part required by the laboratory.	Young and older leaves collected together and kept as separately identified samples.
Measurement	Nutrient concentrations in dried plant material, reported on a dry-matter basis.	Nutrient concentrations in extracted leaf fluid, reported separately for each leaf age. The panel may also include sugars, pH and EC.
Useful for	Assessing the sampled tissue against a suitable crop-stage reference and following consistent repeat samples.	Comparing the two leaf ages at a crop stage, then following changes across comparable repeat pairs.

The methods can complement one another. Sampling protocols, units and reference values differ, so the numbers are not directly interchangeable. Neither test establishes the cause of a result on its own.

Build a seasonal record

A series of comparable DSAs at relevant crop stages builds a record of how the young and older leaf results change through the season. Read alongside applications, weather, crop load and harvest or quality records, it can help identify recurring Nutrient concerns and refine the following season's timing and prescriptions.

Keep the crop-stage context when comparing results and seasons, and agree sampling frequency with your agronomist around useful decisions.

Paired samples	Across crop stages	Season review
Compare the two leaf ages	Review comparable repeat pairs	Refine next season's plan

> DSA measures leaf-fluid concentrations; it does not directly measure whole-tree reserves or stored carbohydrates. A trend needs field context before its cause can be established.

Hybrid-Ag: Differential Leaf Extract Test (hybridag.com.au/dsatest); Hybrid-Ag Testing Guide 2026; current leaf-testing review material. Technical review required before external use.